

added features in the post processing stage to get a more soulful shot. So post processing may not necessarily be a procedure that you'll want to try out on all your photos (sometimes the originals are better left that way!) but whenever you want to get a certain look just right, it's always a welcome help.

Let us start with what most professionals now refer to as a digital image editing “workflow”. This is simply a series of steps to guide to you in the quickest way through the process. It is not a rule but merely a guideline that you can tweak to your requirements once you are comfortable with the whole process. What you basically will be doing is- transferring your pictures from the camera/ card into your computer, editing and cleaning them by adjusting elements in your photo like the white balance, exposure, noise reduction etc in different layers, cropping them to remove any distracting



Example of what post processing can do to your photographs

section or as per your need, and finally saving the finished picture in the required format. Obviously the critical step here is the editing part where your intuition and aesthetic sense as a photographer will matter most, and which can really make or break the “look” you are trying to achieve. In this section we’ll go through what are the main elements you’ll need to alter, and how to actually do so. Since most steps you’ll follow are fairly standard and universal so most photo editing software should work.

Adjusting the white balance

One of the first things you should adjust is the white balance (WB) of your photo. WB is the process of removing unrealistic color casts so that objects appear white in person when rendered white in your image. The color temperature of the light source is to be taken into account here, meaning the relative warmth or coolness of white light as you physically see it. Since the correct white balance affects the entire feel of a picture, right from the color saturation to the contrasts, it’s a crucial parameter to be set right. Fortunately, most digital cameras contain a variety of preset white balances so during critical shots you don’t have to deal with color temperatures every time. In